MIL-C-43135H
30 March 1981
SUPERSEDING
USED IN-LIEU-OF
MIL-C-0043135G(GL)
and
MIL-C-43135F
9 November 1976

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

# CHICKEN AND CHICKEN PRODUCTS COOKED, DEHYDRATED

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

## 1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirements for cooked, freeze-dehydrated chicken and chicken products for use by the Department of Defense as a component of operational rations.

1.2 Classification. The product shall be of the following types as specified (see 6.1):

Types

I - Chicken diced
II - Chicken stew

## 2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Issues of documents. The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: US Army Natick Research and Development Laboratories, Natick, MA 01760 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

☆U.S. GOVERNMENT PRINTING OFFICE: 1981—703-023/1973

FSC 8905

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-21T20:46Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| C-M-350 | - | Milk, Nonfat Dry |
| L-P-378 | - | Plastic Sheet and Strip, Thin Gauge, Polyolefin |
| N-C-541 | - | Starches, Edible |
| EE-B-575 | - | Bouillon (Soup and Gravy Bases) |
| EE-M-591 | - | Monosodium Glutamate |
| EE-S-631 | - | Spices: Ground and Whole and Spice Blends |
| PP-C-248 | - | Chickens, Chilled and Frozen (Ready-to-cook) |
| TT-C-495 | - | Coating, Exterior, For Tinned Food Cans |
| PPP-B-26 | - | Bag, Plastic, (General Purpose) |
| PPP-B-636 | - | Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard |
| PPP-C-96 | - | Cans, Metal, 28 Gage and Lighter |
| PPP-C-843 | - | Cushioning Material, Cellulosic |
| PPP-C-1797 | - | Cushioning Material, Resilient, Low Density, Unicellular, Polypropylene Foam |
| PPP-T-60 | - | Tape, Packaging, Waterproof |

MILITARAY

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| MIL-L-1497 | - | Labeling of Metal Cans for Subsistence Items |
| MIL-L-35078 | - | Loads, Unit: Preparation of Nonperishable Subsistence |

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| FED-STD-101 | - | Preservation, Packaging and Packing Materials: Test Procedures |
| FED-STD-595 | - | Colors |

MILITARY

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| MIL-STD-105 | - | Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes |
| MIL-STD-129 | - | Marking for Shipment and Storage |
| MIL-STD-668 | - | Sanitary Standards for Food Plants |

(Copies of specifications, standards and publications required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions, should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-21T20:46Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

LAWS AND REGULATIONS

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE

Regulations Governing the Grading and Inspection of Poultry and Edible Products Thereof and United States Classes, Standards, and Grades with Respect Thereto (7CFR, Part 70)

(Application for copies should be addressed to U.S. Department of Agriculture, Information Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, Washington, DC 20250.)

U.S. Standards for Condition of Food Containers
U.S. Standards for Grades of Frozen Carrots
U.S. Standards for Grades of Frozen Peas

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Mathematics and Statistics Division, Food Safety and Quality Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

* 2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

U.S. PHARMACOPOEIAL CONVENTION, INC.

Pharmacopoeia of the United States

(Application for copies should be addressed to the U.S. Pharmacopoeial Convention, Inc., Mack Publishing Company, 20th and Northhampton Sts., Easton, PA 18042.)

ASSOCIATION OF OFFICIAL ANALYTICAL CHEMISTS

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, 1111 North 19th Street, Suite 210, Arlington, VA 22209.)



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T20:46Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS

D 882 - Tensile Properties of Thin Plastic Sheeting

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

AMERICAN DEHYDRATED ONION AND GARLIC ASSOCIATION

Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association (ADOGA)

(Application for copies should be addressed to The American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association, 601 California Street, San Francisco, CA 94108.)

UNIFORM CLASSIFICATION COMMITTEE, AGENT

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606)

NATIONAL MOTOR FREIGHT TRAFFIC ASSOCIATION, INC., AGENT

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addresssed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

(Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified (see 6.1), the contractor shall furnish a sample for first article inspection and approval (see 4.4 and 6.5).

* 3.2 Material. All material shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and free from foreign and undesirable odors, flavors, and extraneous materials. Materials shall be so handled and processed that the final product shall conform to the end product requirements of 3.4 through 3.4.3, as applicable.

3.2.1 Chicken. The chicken shall meet the commodity requirements for type I or IV, class 1 or 2, style 1 through 5 of PP-C-248. Identity of bird type, age, quality and wholesomeness will be certified by the U.S. Department of Agriculture. When chicken parts are used they shall be used in their natural proportions (light-dark meat) except that white meat may be used in excess of natural proportions. If type IV frozen chickens are used, they shall have been maintained during storage at a temperature of 0°F (-18°C), or lower and shall have been properly packaged and wrapped so as to avoid freezer burn or other damage. The poultry shall not have been in frozen storage longer than 120 days prior to thawing for use in the product. The product shall be in excellent condition and shall show no evidence of thawing or refreezing.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T20:46Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.2.2 Carrots. Carrots shall be either fresh or frozen complying with 3.2.2.1 or 3.2.2.2, as applicable.

3.2.2.1 Carrots, frozen. Frozen carrots shall comply with the requirements for U.S. Grade B or better of U.S. Standards for Grades of Frozen Carrots. The frozen carrots shall be mechanically diced and the dicer settings at approximately 3/8 by 3/8 by 3/8 inch (10 by 10 by 10 mm).

3.2.2.2 Carrots fresh. Fresh carrots shall be washed, peeled, sorted, trimmed and blanched in accordance with commercial practice. The fresh carrots shall be mechanically diced with dicer settings at approximately 3/8 by 3/8 by 3/8 inch (10 by 10 by 10 mm).

3.2.3 Monosodium glutamate. Monosodium glutamate shall comply with the requirements of EE-M-591.

3.2.4 Nitrogen. The nitrogen shall meet the requirements of the Pharmacopoeia of the United States and, in addition, shall be water or liquid nitrogen pumped.

3.2.5 Milk, dry, nonfat. Nonfat dry milk shall comply with the requirements of C-M-350.

3.2.6 Onions and garlic dehydrated. The onions shall be dehydrated, minced onions and the garlic powder shall conform to "fancy" grade of the official standards of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products.

3.2.7 Peas, frozen. Frozen peas shall meet the requirements for U.S. Grade B or better of U.S. Standards for Grades of Frozen Peas. Peas shall be slit or perforated to improve rehydration characteristics.

3.2.8 Pepper, white. White pepper shall comply with the requirements for type II of EE-S-631.

3.2.9 Potatoes. Potatoes shall be one of the following varieties: Russet Burbank, Kennebec, Green Mountain, Cobbler, Red McClure, Sebago, Katahdin or Snowflake. The potatoes shall be washed, sorted, peeled, trimmed to remove defects, and mechanically diced with dicer setting at approximately 3/8 by 3/8 by 3/8 inch (10 by 10 by 10 mm) before being cooked. The potatoes shall be processed according to commercial practice. Dehydrated or dehydro frozen potatoes shall not be used.

3.2.10 Poultry seasoning. Poultry seasoning shall comply with the requirements of EE-S-631.

3.2.11 Salt. Salt shall be white, refined, non-iodized flowing sodium chloride with or without anticaking agents.

3.2.12 Soup and gravy base, chicken-flavored. Chicken flavored soup and gravy base shall comply with the type II requirements of EE-B-575.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T20:46Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.2.13 Starch, pregelatinized, edible. Instant starch shall comply with the commodity requirements for type II of N-C-541.

3.2.14 Vegetable oil. The vegetable oil shall be a bland flavored, winterized, bleached, deodorized corn oil. The oil shall be stabilized with butylated hydroxyanisole or butylated hydroxytoluene or both in equal amounts. Total quantity of stabilizer shall be 0.02 percent maximum by weight of oil.

3.3 Processing.

3.3.1 Chicken.

* 3.3.1.1 Preparation. In addition the raw chicken meat following preparation (see 3.2.1) shall meet the following requirements.

(a) The carcass or parts shall be skinned and raw boned.
(b) There shall be no heads, feet, metacarpus - phalanges sections of wings, giblets, or viscera.
(c) There shall be no bones, coarse connective tissue, blood clots, skin, bruised or discolored meat exceeding 1/4 inch (6 mm) in any dimension.
(d) There shall be no ligaments, tendons or cartilage exceeding 1/4 inch (6 mm) in any dimension.
(e) The chicken meat shall not be ground through plates with holes smaller than 1-1/2 inches (38 mm) in diameter. No mechanically deboned chicken meat shall be used.

The chicken meat shall not have been frozen more than three times including final freezing for dehydration. Any intermediate stage of preparation necessitating holding of the product within limits specified in table I shall require prompt cooling to 40°F (4°C) or below. Preparation, cooking, dicing, formulation and dehydration shall be conducted so that the final dry product shall comply with the finished product requirements of 3.4.

3.3.1.2 Cooking and dicing. The chicken or parts shall be cooked in suitable casings or metal molds by any suitable means until tender. A minimum internal temperature of 170°F (77°C) shall be reached during the cooking process. Salt may be used in the preparation of the cooked chicken but shall not exceed a total of 1.25 percent in the cooked product. If salt is used, the formula for type II product shall be adjusted to compensate for the added salt. If the cooked, boned chicken meat is to be held or shipped before dicing it shall be stuffed tightly into casings. If frozen meat is used, or fresh meat is frozen during any stage of preparation and holding, it shall not be thawed and refrozen more than twice before it is to be used in the formulation of the final product (see also 3.3.1.1). However, tempering the frozen meat to a temperature of not more than 30°F (-1°C) to facilitate dicing shall not be considered thawing, provided that the diced product is placed in a freezer at 0°F (-18°C) or lower immediately after dicing. The chicken meat shall be diced by machine with dicer settings adjusted to approximately 1 by 1 by 3/8 inches (25 by 25 by 10 mm) for type I product and 1/2 by 1/2 by 1/4 inches (13 by 13 by 6 mm) for type II product.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-21T20:46Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.3.2 Type I product (chicken diced). Type I product shall be prepared by freezing and freeze drying the diced chicken.

3.3.3 Type II product (chicken stew). Chicken stew shall be prepared in accordance with the following formula: 1/

| | Percent by weight |
|---|---|
| Chicken, cooked, diced | 20.0 |
| Potatoes, diced, raw | 25.1 |
| Peas, slit or perforated | 6.5 |
| Carrots, diced | 8.0 |
| Vegetable oil | 2.5 |
| Water | 32.5 |
| Gravy mix | 5.4 |
| | 100.0 |

Gravy mix

| | |
|---|---|
| Soup and gravy base, chicken flavored | 27.78 |
| Poultry seasoning | 0.24 |
| Monosodium glutamate | 0.11 |
| Nonfat dry milk | 33.66 |
| Starch, instant | 33.66 |
| Pepper, white | 0.67 |
| Garlic powder | 0.10 |
| Onions, dehydrated | 3.78 |
| | 100.00 |

1/ The total amount of the salt in the formula shall equal 1.25 percent. If sufficient salt is not contributed by the chicken, soup and gravy base and monosodium glutamate, then salt shall be added to the formula as necessary to bring the total salt level to 1.25 percent.

Gravy mix ingredients and water shall be mixed thoroughly. Peas, carrots, potatoes, and oil shall be added and the mixture heated to a minimum of 185°F (85°C) while stirring, until tender. Stirring shall be gentle enough so that the cooked vegetables are not broken up. The diced chicken shall be added and the mixture heated to a minimum of 180°F (82°C). Any process which produces an equivalent product shall be acceptable. The prepared product shall be spread on dehydrator trays, frozen and freeze dehydrated.

3.3.4 Dehydration. The chicken dices and chicken stew shall be freeze dehydrated at an absolute pressure not to exceed 1.5 millimeters of mercury (0.2 kPa) and a product temperature as indicated by suitable instruments, not to exceed 150°F (66°C).



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-21T20:46Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

If the platen temperature is maintained at 155°F (68°C) or below with radiant heating, the product temperature may be disregarded. After dehydration is completed, the pressure shall be equalized to atmospheric level with nitrogen, and the product shall be preserved as specified in 5.1. If it becomes necessary to hold the product more than 2 hours between dehydration and preservation, the product shall be adequately protected from oxygen and moisture by either holding under a nitrogen atmosphere with 2.0 percent or less oxygen, or under a vacuum of at least 27 inches of mercury (9.8 kPa absolute pressure) for the entire period. If vacuum is used, it shall be broken with nitrogen.

3.3.5 Time and temperature limitations. The products shall be so handled as to comply with table I.

Table I. Time and temperature limitations for handling and storage of component chicken and chicken meat 1/

| Stage | Maximum holding period | Maximum temperature |
|---|---|---|
| Chilled chicken or chicken meat | | |
| Stage 1 | | |
| a. From preparation (3.3.1.1) to completion of cooking. 2/ | 72 hours | 40°F (4°C) |
| b. After cooling, in rolls, or logs, to start of dicing. | 72 hours | 40°F (4°C) 3/ |
| c. Between dicing and freeze dehydration of type I product or formulation of type II product. | 48 hours | 40°F (4°C) |
| d. After formulation, before freezing for dehydration (type II). | 24 hours | 40°F (4°C) |
| e. Total time - all stages combined (preparation, cooking, dicing and formulation before freezing for dehydration). | 8 days (type I)<br>9 days (type II) | |
| Frozen chicken or chicken meat (after preparation and cooking, see stage 1a, above | | |
| Stage 2 | | |
| a. Total freezer time - all stages combined (raw, cooked and diced). | 60 days | 0°F (-18°C) |
| Cooked rolls or logs. | 45 days | 0°F (-18°C) |
| After dicing. | 15 days | 0°F (-18°C) |
| b. Between dicing and freeze dehydration of type I product or formulation of type II product. | 30 days 4/ | 0°F (-18°C) |
| c. Between frozen prepared products and placement of same in the dehydrator (applicable to type II product). | 5 days | 0°F (-18°C) |



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-21T20:46Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE I. Time and temperature limitations for handling and storage of component chicken and chicken meat 1/ (cont'd)

| Stage | Maximum holding period | Maximum temperature |
|---|---|---|
| Frozen chicken or chicken meat (after preparation and cooking, see stage 1a, above (cont'd) | | |
| Stage 3 (in transit) | | |
| d. Maximum internal temperature of frozen raw or cooked meat at the completion of any transit between plants (product shall be placed in 0°F (-18°C) or lower freezer immediately upon receipt). | - | 10°F (-12°C) |

1/ The various increments of time specified for each stage of handling or processing are given to permit maximum flexibility to the contractor and to the processor. At no stage shall the quality of the the product show any evidence of deterioration in its organoleptic properties.

2/ Following cooking, internal product temperature of 40°F (4°C) or less, when chilling is intended, shall be reached within 24 hours; if product is to be frozen, internal temperature of 0°F (-18°C) or less shall be reached within 48 hours.

3/ Maximum temperature permissible for tempering in preparation for dicing as specified in 3.3.1.2.

4/ The key word is "dicing". Example: Of the total 60-day maximum permitted under 2(a), if the rolls are diced within 10 days of manufacture, it is necessary to process the diced chicken within a 30-day period, even if the total of 60 days has not elasped.

3.4 Finished product.

3.4.1 Physical characteristics.

* 3.4.1.1 Type I chicken diced. The dehydrated, cooked diced chicken shall meet the following requirements.

(1) Not more than 10 percent by weight of the product shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 3-1/2 sieve with moderate shaking so as to permit all undersized pieces to drop through the sieve without injury to the larger intact pieces. No product retained on a screen with 1 inch (25 mm) holes shall have a dimension larger than 1-1/8 inches (29 mm).



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-21T20:46Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

(2) There shall be no harmful foreign material (visible to the unaided vision) visually determined to be metal, glass, hard plastic, wood splinters, other hard materials, chemicals, paint or insect parts.

(3) There shall be no foreign material of a type used in the processing such as casing or string.

(4) There shall be no evidence of thawing in the dehydrator such as glazed surface areas measuring more than 1/2 inch (13 mm) in any dimension or dark colored areas of any dimension.

(5) There shall be no evidence of incomplete dehydration such as damp or soggy areas.

(6) At least 50 percent by weight of the product shall be light meat.

(7) When rehydrated with an excess of hot water 180 to 200°F (82 to 93°C) for 20 minutes, the product shall show complete water penetration. Since gristle, gelatinous material, and connective tissue frequently tend to impede proper rehydration, callous-like areas ascribable to these conditions will not be considered evidence of improper rehydration.

(8) The rehydrated product shall possess flavor, odor and texture in ranges considered normal for freeze-dried product of the same type. The product shall be free from scorched, burned or foreign flavors or odors.

(9) The texture of the rehydrated product shall be in a range considered normal for roasted or steamed, freeze-dried chicken of comparable class and type.

* 3.4.1.2 Type II, chicken stew. The dehydrated chicken stew shall comply with the following physical characteristics:

(1) There shall be no foreign material such as, but not limited to, dirt, glass or paint.

(2) There shall be no evidence of incomplete dehydration such as damp or soggy areas.

(3) There shall be no soft extraneous material of the type used in processing (paper, string, casing material, etc.) or smears and stains which have an aggregate area of more than that of a circle 1/2 inch (13 mm) in diameter.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 20260-21T20:46Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

(4) When rehydrated in hot water 180° to 200°F (82° to 93°C) using the ratio of 13 ounces (384 mL) of water to 4-5/8 ounces (131 g) of dehydrated chicken stew for 10 minutes, the product shall show complete water penetration through all dice and particles. 1/ However, callous-like areas ascribable to gristle, gelatinous material, and connective tissue hindering rehydration in the chicken shall not be considered evidence of improper rehydration. Dry areas in potatoes similarly shall not be considered evidence of improper rehydration.

(5) The rehydrated chicken stew shall possess flavor, odor and texture in ranges considered normal for freeze dehydrated chicken stew. The product shall be free from scorched, burned or foreign flavors or odors.

(6) The rehydrated chicken stew shall show distinct dice of chicken, carrots, potatoes and whole peas.

1/ Up to, but not exceeding, two ounces (59 mL) of additional hot water may be added to aid in rehydration and improve consistency of the product.

3.4.2 Analytical requirements. Product shall comply with the following analytical requirements on a unit basis:

| | Percent maximum | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Type | Moisture | Fat | Oxygen 1/ |
| I | 2.0 | 23.0 | 2.0 |
| II | 2.0 | --- | 2.0 |

1/ In headspace gas when gas packed.

* 3.4.3 Microbiological requirements. The product shall comply with the following microbiological requirements.

| Test | Limit per gram | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | n | c | m | M |
| Aerobic plate count (APC) | 5 | 1 | $<7.5 \times 10^4$ | $10^5$ |
| E. coli | 5 | 1 | <3 | 10 |

n..... The number of 25 gram units to be examined

c..... The maximum number of sample units which may have counts above "m" but not greater than "M"

m..... The level of the test organism which is acceptable ($7.5 \times 10^4$ or less)

M..... Counts above "M" are unacceptable



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-21T20:46Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

3.5 Plant qualification. The product shall originate, be processed, marked and handled in plants which are operated under the Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations of the U.S. Department of Agriculture. Finished product refrigeration facilities (freezer, storage and shipping) not operating under these regulations shall meet the requirements of MIL-STD-668.

3.6 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

* 4.2 Classification of inspection.

a. First article inspection (see 4.4).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.5).

* 4.3 Plant qualification conditions. The product shall be unacceptable if produced and stored in plants not meeting the requirements specified in 3.5.

* 4.4 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.1), it shall be examined for the defects specified in table VIII and tested as specified in 4.6.2 through 4.6.5, as applicable. The presence of any defect or failure of the test shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

* 4.5 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.5.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings, and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T20:46Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.5.1.1 Examination of chicken. Examination of the chicken shall be made in accordance with the examination criteria of the referenced specification in 3.2.1 to determine conformance to the pertinent commodity requirements contained therein and to determine conformance to the condition and identity requirements of 3.2 and 3.2.1. Records of all applicable control data (temperature and storage time) shall be maintained. Nonconformance to one or more condition or identity requirements or to temperature and storage requirements reflected by actual examination or by records shall be cause for rejection of the involved quantity of product or the finished product made therefrom, as applicable. Conformance to the identity requirements shall be ascertained by examination of USDA certificate.

* 4.5.1.2 Examination of garlic powder, monosodium glutamate, pregelatinized starch, dry milk, dehydrated onions, pepper, poultry seasoning, and soup and gravy base. Each of the ingredients shall be examined to determine conformance to 3.2 and to the finished product requirements in accordance with the applicable subsidiary specifications, except that the sampling plans and acceptance criteria shall not apply. The sample for examination shall be an approximate 1 pound (454 g) composite for nonfat dry milk and an approximate 4 ounce (113 g) composite for each of the other ingredients, derived from five primary containers, or all containers if five or less form a lot. The amount of product for sieve examination as applicable, shall be as specified in the pertinent component specification.

* 4.5.1.3 Examination of frozen carrots and peas. Examination of frozen carrots and peas shall be made to determine compliance with the condition requirements of 3.2 and grade requirements of 3.2.2.1 and 3.2.7. The sample for condition examination shall be a 10 pound (4.5 kg) composite derived from five primary containers or all containers if less than five form a lot. Examination for the grade requirements shall be ascertained by the examination of labels, invoices, grade certificate or other valid documents. In addition, the peas shall be examined to determine conformance to the slit or perforation requirements of 3.2.7. Nonconformance to one or more of the above referenced requirements reflected by actual examination or by records shall be cause for rejection of the component lot, or end item as applicable.

* 4.5.1.4 Examination of fresh carrots, potatoes, salt and vegetable oil. Examination shall be made to determine compliance with the condition requirements of 3.2 and the applicable identity and condition requirements of the pertinent product paragraph. The sample unit for examination of the condition requirements shall be 10 pounds (4.5 kg) of carrots or potaties and 1 pound (454 g) of salt and 1 quart (0.95 liter) of vegetable oil. Determination of compliance with the identity requirements shall be ascertained by examination of labels, invoices or USDA grade certificates. Nonconformance to one or more of the above requirements reflected by actual examination or by records shall be cause for rejection of the component lot or end item as applicable.

4.5.1.5 Examination of nitrogen. Examination of labels, invoices and similar documents shall be made to determine compliance with requirements of 3.2.4. Nonconformance to requirements of 3.2.4 shall indicate an unacceptable ingredient, and use of such shall be cause for rejection of the component or the involved quantity of finished product.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-21T20:46Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

* 4.5.2 Testing of components. In addition to testing provisions contained in referenced documents, components shall be tested for the characteristics specified in table II. Results shall be applicable to the lot average except for laminated plastic-foil bag material which shall be both lot average and unit specimen requirements and for cans for which the average for tin plating applies separately to top ends, bottom ends, and bodies. Any nonconformance to test requirements shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

*TABLE II. Component tests

| Component | Sample unit | Lot size expressed in | Inspection level | Characteristics | Results reported to | Test ref. and rqmts. para. |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Cans and lids 1/ | One can and lid | Cans | S-1 | Tin plate | Nearest 0.01 lb/ base box | 4.6.7<br>5.1.1 |
| Polyethylene bag | One bag | Bags | S-1 | Thickness 2/ | Nearest 0.0001 inch (0.001 mm) | 4.6.8<br>5.1.2.1 |
| | | | | Seal strength | Nearest 1/4 lb. (0.01 kN/m) | 4.6.6<br>5.1.2.1 |
| Cooked chicken component | 8 oz. (227 g) composite | Pounds | 3/ | Salt | Nearest 0.01 percent | 4.6.4<br>3.3.1.2 |
| Plastic foil laminated bag material | Bag or sheet | Bags or sheets | S-1 | Seal strength | Nearest 1/4 lb. (0.01 kN/m) | 4.6.6<br>5.1.2.2<br>5.1.2.2.1 |
| Ionomer | | | | Thickness 2/ | Nearest 0.0001 inch (0.001 mm) | 4.6.1.2<br>5.1.2.2 |
| Aluminum | | | | Thickness 2/ | Nearest 0.00001 inch (0.0001 mm) | 4.6.1.2<br>5.1.2.2 |
| Polyethylene | | | | Weight 2/ | Nearest 1 lb. (0.1 kg) | 5.1.2.2 |



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-21T20:46Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

*TABLE II. Component tests (cont'd)

| Component | Sample unit | Lot size expressed in | In-spection level | Character-istics | Results reported to | Test ref. and rqmts. para. |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Poly-ester or nylon 6 | | | | Thickness 2/ | Nearest 0.001 inch (0.01 mm) | 4.6.1.2 5.1.2.2 |
| Tape | Roll | Rolls | S-1 | Tensile strength | Nearest pound (0.1 kN/m) | 4.6.9 5.1.2.1 |
| Baseboard | Board | Boards | S-1 | Thickness | Nearest 0.001 inch (0.001 mm) | 4.6.10 5.1.2.1.2 |

1/ Exterior can coating, when required, and can label shall be tested in accordance with the applicable subsidiary specifications except that tests shall be performed on the same cans submitted for tinplate testing with additional cans as required to complete the sampling plan of TT-C-495.

2/ In lieu of testing for thickness requirement, determination may be made by examination of labels, invoices or other valid documents. Nonconformance to thickness requirements shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

3/ The composite shall be derived from five primary containers or all containers if less than five form a lot.

* 4.5.3 In-process inspection. Examination shall be made to determine compliance with the formulation requirements and with the requirements pertinent to processing procedures, controls and equipment of 3.3 (except for the requirements of 3.3.1.1). Records shall be maintained reflecting formulations, pressure, time, and temperature. Nonconformance to requirements as determined by actual examination or as reflected by the records shall be cause for rejection of the involved quantity of product.

* 4.5.3.1 In-process examination of chicken. Defects found during examination shall be classified as shown below. Lot size shall be expressed as the pounds of chicken. The inspection level shall be S-3. The sample unit shall be 1 pound (454 g), as applicable. The acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 4.0 major B defects and 10.0 minor defects per hundred units.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-21T20:46Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

| Category | | Defect |
|---|---|---|
| Major B | Minor | |
| 151 | | Not skinned or raw boned. |
| 152 | | Presence of head, feet, metacarpus-phalanges section of wings, giblet or viscera. |
| 153 | | Presence of bone, coarse connective tissue, blood clots, skin, bruised or discolored meat exceeding 1/4 inch (6 mm) in any dimension. 1/ |
| | 201 | Presence of ligaments, tendons or cartilage exceeding 1/4 inch (6 mm) |
| 154 | | Chicken meat ground through plates with holes smaller than 1-1/2 inches (38 mm). Mechanically deboned chicken meat used. |

1/ Measure to nearest 1/8 inch (3 mm).

* 4.5.4 End item and packaging inspection. Classification of defects found during examination shall be in accordance with tables IV through VIII and table IX when applicable. The inspection levels and AQLs shall be as shown in table III. AQLs shall be expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, for tables IV, V, VII, and XI and as percent defective for tables VI and VIII.

TABLE III. Criteria for end item sampling

| Table | Inspection level | Sample unit | Lot size expresssed in | AQLs Major A | AQLs Major B | AQLs Minor |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| IV | S-2 | One bag | Bags | - | 2.5 | 6.5 |
| V | S-3 | One bag | Bags | - | 1.5 | 6.5 |
| VI | S-3 | One primary container | Primary containers | - | - | 2.5 |
| VII | S-2 | Contents of one primary container | Primary containers | 1/ | 1.5 | 6.5 |
| VIII | S-3 | One primary container | Primary containers | _ | 0.65 | - |
| IX | S-3 | One shipping container | Shipping containers | - | 1.5 | 6.5 |

1/ Finding of one or more major A defects shall be cause for rejection of the lot.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T20:46Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

*TABLE IV. Examination of polyethylene and laminated foil bag before filling and sealing 1/

| Category | | Defect | Polyethylene bag | Laminated plastic-foil bag |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Major B | Minor | | | |
| 151 | | Not style or material specified | X | X |
| 152 | | Three edges not heat sealed | | X |
| | 201 | Lip does not extend 1/4 inch (6 mm) beyond outer edge (when applicable) 2/ | | X |
| | 202 | "V" or "C" shaped tear notch less than 1/32 inch (1 mm) deep or distance between inside edge of notch and inside edge of seal less than 3/16 inch (5 mm) 2/ | | X |
| | 203 | "V" or "C" shaped notch not located between 1-1/4 to 1-1/2 inch (32 to 38 mm) from top edge of bag or not in both side seals 2/ | | X |
| 153 | | Dimensions not as specified (see 5.1.2.1 and 5.1.2.2) | X | X |
| 154 | | Color of exterior not as specified (see 5.1.2.2) | | X |
| | 204 | Tape missing or not placed over ears when applicable (see 5.1.2.1) | X | |
| 155 | | Width of heat seal less than 1/4 inch (6 mm) | | X |
| | | (Applicable to baseboard) | | |
| | 205 | Baseboard material not as specified | X | |
| | 206 | Not a natural color ranging from brown to gray when applicable | X | |
| | 207 | Not dimension specified | X | |
| | 208 | Corners not rounded | X | |

1/ Bag dimensions are inside dimensions exclusive of seams or seals. Deviations from bag dimensions due to seal creep or seams not being parallel to each other shall be scored as a defect.

2/ Measure to nearest 1/16 inch (1 mm).



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T20:46Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE V. Examination of the polyethylene and laminated foil bag after filling and sealing

| Category | | Defect | Polyethylene bag | Laminated plastic-foil bag |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Major B | Minor | | | |
| 151 | | Not formed as specified | X | X |
| 152 | | Broken, sifter, tear or hole | X | X |
| | 201 | Maximum thickness exceeds 2-1/4 inches (57 mm) at any point 1/ | X | |
| | 202 | Not folded as specified | X | |
| 153 | | Not clean | X | X |
| 154 | | Name of product missing, incorrect illegible | | X |
| | 203 | Other markings missing, incorrect or illegible | | X |
| 155 | | Color of label white or other than dull nonreflecting color | | X |
| 156 | | Printing not bold black face or indelible ink 2/ | | X |
| | 204 | Label not affixed as specified | | X |
| 157 | | Double closure seal width less than 5/16 inch (8 mm) | | X |
| 158 | | Seal closure width less than 1/4 inch (6 mm) or 1/8 inch (3 mm) as applicable or more than 1/2 inch (13 mm) 3/ | | X |
| | 205 | Tear notch not below closure seal | | X |

1/ Measure to the nearest 1/4 inch (6 mm).

2/ When applicable, determination of compliance to the indelible ink requirements shall be ascertained by examination of labels, invoices or other valid documents.

3/ Measure to nearest 1/32 inch (1 mm).



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T20:46Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE VI. Examination of filled and sealed can or bag for net weight 1/

| Category | | Defect |
|---|---|---|
| Minor | | Contents of can or bag less than (ounces) |
| 201 | Type I | 19-3/4 (560 g) |
| 202 | Type II | 4-1/2 (128 g) |

1/ Results shall be reported to nearest 1/8 ounce (1 g) for cans and to a tolerance of 1/32 ounce (1 g) for bags. The lot shall be rejected if sample data indicates the lot average net weight is less than the specified net weight.

*TABLE VII. Examination of finished product

| Category | | | Defect |
|---|---|---|---|
| Major A | Major B | Minor | Dehydrated product |
| 101 | | | Presence of foreign material, such as but not limited to glass, paint, insect or insect parts, dirt or presence of foreign material of a type used in the processing such as casing or string. |
| 102 | | | Presence of scorched, burned or foreign flavors, smear or stains with an aggregate area of more than 1/2 inch (13 mm) circle and odors in rehydrated product (see applicable rehydrating instructions in 3.4.1). |
| 103 | | | Presence of chemical odor. |
| | | 201 | Product retained on a screen with 1 inch (25 mm) holes with a dimension larger than 1-1/8 inches (29 mm) (type I product). |
| | 151 | | More than 10 percent by weight passes through a U.S. Standard No. 3-1/2 sieve with moderate shaking (type I product), (see 3.4.1.1, item 1). 1/ |



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-21T20:46Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

TABLE VII. Examination of finished product (cont'd)

| Category | | | Defect |
|---|---|---|---|
| Major A | Major B | Minor | Dehydrated product |
| | 152 | | Evidence of incomplete dehydration, e.g., damp or soggy areas. |
| | 153 | | Evidence of thawing in the dehydrator, i.e., presence of glazed surface areas measuring more than 1/2 inch (13 mm) in any dimension or presence of dark colored areas of any dimension. 1/ |
| | 154 | | Less than 50 percent by weight is light meat (type I product only). 1/ |
| | | | Rehydrated product (see 3.4.1.1 or 3.4.1.2 as applicable) |
| | 155 | | Product not completely rehydrated. 2/ |
| | 156 | | Type II product does not show distinct dice of chicken, carrots, potatoes and whole peas. |
| | 157 | | Does not possess flavor, odor and texture in range considered normal for freeze dried products of applicable type. 3/ Product is not comparable to First Article sample. |
| | 158 | | Vegetable not completely rehydrated. |

1/ Report percent to the nearest whole number and linear measurements to nearest 1/16 inch (1 mm).

2/ Dry areas in potatoes and dry or callous-like areas attributable to gristle, gelatinous material and connective tissue in the chicken meat shall not be considered as defects.

3/ Presence of burnt or foreign flavor or odor shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

TABLE VIII Examination for leakage and delamination

| Category | Defect |
|---|---|
| Major B | |
| 151 | Steady progression of bubbles (applicable to cans). 1/ |
| 152 | Delamination (applicable to bags). |

1/ See 4.6.11 for procedure.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T20:46Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

*TABLE IX. Examination of packing (applicable to level C, flexible packages)

| Category | | Defect |
|---|---|---|
| Major B | Minor | |
| | 201 | Not material specified (see 5.2.4). |
| | 202 | Less than 44 packages (see 5.2.4) 1/ |
| 151 | | Liner missing. |
| 152 | | Pad or pads missing. |
| | 203 | Arrangement not as specified. |
| 153 | | NSN, item nomenclature, contract number and date of pack missing, incorrect or illegible. |
| | 204 | Excess package material not maintained in the flat (unfolded) state. |
| | 205 | Dunnage material not placed as specified. |
| | 206 | Dimensions of dunnage material not as specified (see 5.2.4). 2/ |
| | 207 | Top or bottom pads missing or not constructed of same material as shipping container. |
| | 208 | Other required markings missing, incorrect, or illegible. |

1/ Lot shall be rejected if the average count is less than the specified count.

2/ Report thickness to nearest 1/16 inch (2 mm) for 1/8 inch (3 mm) material and to nearest 1/32 inch (1 mm) for the 1/16 inch (2 mm) material.

4.5.4.1 Examination for loss of vacuum of unit pack (food packet). The evacuated packets shall be examined on a 100 percent basis to determine compliance with the vacuum requirements of 5.1.2.2.1. The examination shall be made not less than 24 hours after sealing. During the examination, the packet shall continue to exhibit a tight adherence of the bag to the surface contour of the contents along the seam when a force is applied away from the contents at the center of each side seam (holding each side seam between thumb and forefinger of each hand, simultaneously exert a slight pull with both hands). Repacking of the product into a new laminated foil-plastic bag will be permitted provided that the repacking and resealing is accomplished within 7 days of the original sealing. Any bag showing a vacuum failure shall be rejected. Records shall be maintained to reflect the 100-percent examination and the results thereof.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-21T20:46Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

* 4.5.4.2 Moisture, fat, headspace oxygen and microbiological testing. The finished product (dehydrated form) shall be tested for moisture, fat (type I only), and headspace oxygen in sealed cans and for microbiological content in accordance with the requirements of 3.4.2 and 3.4.3. Procedures for testing shall be in accordance with 4.6. Test requirements shall be applicable to the sample unit. The sample unit for testing shall be one filled and sealed primary container for types I and II product. Lot size shall be expressed in terms of primary containers, and the sample size shall be the number of sample units indicated by inspection level S-2. For determination of the moisture, fat, oxygen and aerobic plate count. The AQL, expressed as percent defective for each characteristic, shall be 1.5. A nonconformance to a test requirement shall be scored as a defect. For determination of the E. coli count, five samples shall be used. The product shall be rejected if it fails to comply with 3.4.3, footnote 1/. Results for moisture, fat and oxygen shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent, and microbiological counts shall be reported in accordance with AOAC.

* 4.5.4.3 Shipping container examination. Examination of the filled and sealed shipping containers shall be in accordance with the applicable examination criteria contained in the appendix to PPP-B-636. In addition the following defects shall be included in the table of examination: Major: National stock number, item description, contract number or date of pack markings missing, incorrect or illegible. Minor (1) Other required markings missing, incorrect or illegible; (2) Arrangement not as specified. When packing for level C is required to be in accordance with 5.2.4, examination shall be in accordance with table X.

* 4.5.4.4 External examination of cans. External examination of cans shall be performed in accordance with the applicable requirements of the United States Standards *for Condition of Food Containers.*

4.5.4.5 Examination of can coating. Examination of can coating shall be performed in accordance with the examination criteria of TT-C-495.

4.5.4.6 Examination of can labeling. Examination of can labeling shall be in accordance with the examination criteria of MIL-L-1497.

4.5.4.7 Examination of unit loads. Examination of unit loads shall be in accordance with the examination criteria of MIL-L-35078 and the applicable specification sheet for the type and class of load specified.

* 4.6 Methods of inspection.

4.6.1 Oxygen test. Oxygen in the headspace gas (cans) shall be determined in accordance with Standards for Grades of Dry Milks Including Methods of Analysis, Bulletin 916.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-21T20:46Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.6.2 Moisture test. Moisture in the product shall be determined in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists; Chapter: Meat and Meat Products: Section: Meat; Method: Moisture-Drying in Vacuum. Use a temperature of 70°C (158°F) for 16 hours under a pressure of 13 kPa (100 mm Hg).

4.6.3 Fat test. Fat determination shall be made in accordance with Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, Chapter: Meat and Meat Products, Section: Meat; Method: Crude Fat or Ether Extract (using petroleum ether as solvent).

4.6.4 Salt content test. Chemical analysis for salt shall be in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, Chapter: Meat and Meat Products, Section: Meat; Test: Salt (sodium chloride); Method: Salt.

4.6.5 Microbiological test. Microbiological testing of the product shall be made, as applicable, in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, Chapter: Microbiological Methods, Section: Examination of Frozen, Chilled, Precooked, or Prepared Foods - Official First Action, except as specified in 4.6.5.1.

* 4.6.5.1 Preparation and dilution of the food homogenate. The finished product shall be prepared for chemical and microbiological testing by being adequately comminuted, care being taken to avoid contamination of product and moisture pickup. A representative sample shall then be removed and handled as specified in AOAC. For E. coli determinations, prepare proper dilutions using 25 g samples. Following addition of the dilutent to the dry product, allow to stand for 15 minutes before blending. Continue as directed by AOAC.

* 4.6.6 Seal strength test (polyethylene and plastic-foil bags). Seal strength shall be tested in accordance with the procedure specified in Method A or B of ASTM D 882. Seam specimens shall be 1/2 inch or 1 inch (13 mm or 25 mm) in width. Two non-adjacent specimens shall be taken from each of the three manufacturer's seals (bottom seal only of the polyethylene bag) of the bag to be tested. The seal strength of the processor's closure seal shall be determined in the same manner.

4.6.7 Tin coating. Tin coating weights shall be determined by any method specified in PPP-C-96.

4.6.8 Polyethylene. Thickness of polyethylene shall be determined by the method described in L-P-378.

4.6.9 Tape test. Testing of tape shall be in accordance with the criteria of PPP-T-60.

4.6.10 Baseboard thickness test. Thickness of baseboard shall be determined in accordance with Method 1003 of FED-STD-101.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T20:46Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.6.11 Leakage (cans). The filled and sealed container shall be examined for leakage by submerging in water, contained in a desiccator or other suitable container and maintaining a vacuum of 10 inches of mercury (atmospheric pressure 29.9 inches) (6.7 kPa absolute pressure) for at least 30 seconds. A leak is indicated by a steady progression of bubbles. Isolated bubbles caused by entrapped air are not considered as leakers.

4.6.12 Packet material nominal tolerances. The permissible variation of the computed or measured thicknesses from the stated requirements shall be as follows:

a. Polyethylene bag - plus or minus ten percent.

b. Plastic-foil laminated bag:

(1) 0.0025 inch (0.0635 mm) ionomer - plus or minus ten percent.

(2) 0.00035 inch (0.0089 mm) aluminum foil - tolerance; ± 10 percent from stated requirements.

(3) 10 pound (4.5 kg) polyethylene - tolerance; ± 10 percent from stated requirements.

(4) 0.001 inch (0.0254 mm) thick polyester or nylon 6 - tolerance; ± 20 percent of stated requirements.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. The product shall be preserved in accordance with level A or C, as specified (see 6.1), and in the type of unit pack specified.

5.1.1 Level A cans. A net weight of 20 ounces (567 g) of type I product shall be filled into a size 603 by 700 open top style, round, metal can, with soldered or welded side seam and compound-lined, double seamed ends. A minus 1/4 ounce (6 g) tolerance will be allowed in any one container provided the average net weight of the cans inspected in accordance with table VII is not less than 20 ounces (567 g). The cans shall be made throughout from not less than 0.25 pound per base box commercial electrolytic tin plate (see 4.6.7) and shall be coated overall on the outside with a coating conforming to type I of TT-C-495. The product shall be preserved under an atmosphere of nitrogen. The filled and sealed cans shall not leak when tested in accordance with 4.6.11.

5.1.2 Level A, flexible unit packs (type II). The product shall be filled in polyethylene bags as specified in 5.1.2.1. These shall then be unit packed in laminated foil bags as specified in 5.1.2.2.

* 5.1.2.1 Polyethylene bags. A net weight of 4-5/8 ounces (131 g) of type II product shall be filled into a 0.005 inch (0.13 mm) thick ± 10 percent polyethylene bag made in accordance with type I bags of PPP-B-26, except that the bag shall be made from food grade polyethylene. A minus 1/8 ounce (4 g) tolerance will be allowed in any one bag provided the average net weight of the bags inspected in accordance with table VI is not less than 4-5/8 ounces (131 g). If medium, density polyethylene (0.926 to 0.940 $g/cm^3$) is used, a minimum thickness of 0.003 inch (0.08 cm) is acceptable.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-21T20:46Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

The bags shall not impart any undesirable odor or flavor to the product and shall be approved by the Food and Drug Administration for food items. The seal strength of the manufacturer's seal shall be not less than 5 pounds per linear inch (0.9 kN/m) (lot average) when tested in accordance with 4.6.6 with no individual unit evidencing a seal strength specimen of less than 4 pounds per linear inch(0.7 kN/m). The inside dimensions of the bag shall be 5-1/2 by 3-1/2 by 8 inches (140 by 89 by 203 mm) ± 1/8 inch (± 3 mm) in each dimension with the open end of the bag having the 5-1/2 by 3-1/2 inch (140 by 89 mm) dimensions. After filling, the end panels of the bag (corresponding to the 3-1/2 inch (89 mm) dimension) shall be folded in, to form gussets, and the bag shall be closed by folding over its open end. Where required by the bulkiness of the product, the bulk of the contents within the bag shall be compressed to a depth of not more thn 2-1/4 inches (57 mm) by applying a constant uniform pressure over the entire top surface of the product. The filled bag with its open top folded over to prevent spillage of the product shall be inserted to the bottom of the laminated plastic-foil bag specified in 5.1.2.2. Alternatively, in lieu of polyethylene bags conforming to type I of PPP-B-26, bags made in accordance with type II of PPP-B-26, with the inside dimensions of 9 inches (229 mm) by 8 inches (203 mm) (± 1/8 inch (± 3 mm) in each dimension) with the open end of the bag having a 9 inch (229 mm) dimension, may be used. The material and seal strength shall be as specified for type I bags. When type II bags are used, they shall be formed over a baseboard on a mandrel as specified in 5.1.2.1.1 before filling. While the bag is positioned on the mandrel, the two bag ears shall be taped down over a 5-1/2 by 3-1/2 inch (140 by 89 mm) baseboard constructed in accordance with 5.1.2.1.2. An 8 inch (203 mm) long strip of 1 inch (25 mm) wide tape complying with type III, class 2 of PPP-T-60, except that the minimum tensile strength for the wet or dry longitudinal direction, shall be 18 pounds per inch (3.2 kN/m) width and the minimum tensile strength for the wet or dry transverse direction shall be 20 pounds per inch (3.5 kN/m) width, and shall be applied across both ears to fasten them securely to the baseboard.

5.1.2.1.1 Mandrel. The mandrel face shall be 5-3/8 by 3-3/8 inches (137 by 86 mm) and the height shall be not less than 12 inches (305 mm). All corners and edges of the mandrel shall be rounded and all surfaces finished to prevent damage to the bag material.

5.1.2.1.2 Baseboard. The baseboard shall be constructed from unbleached and uncoated solid sulfate or sulfite paperboard not less than 0.022 inch (0.559 mm) thick. Alternatively, the baseboard may be constructed from 0.022 inch (0.559 mm) thick food grade paperboard made from recycled fibers. If paperboard made from recycled fibers is used, it shall be natural color ranging from brown to gray. The baseboard shall be 5-1/2 by 3-1/2 inches (140 by 89 mm) ± 1/8 inch (± 3 mm) and shall have all corners rounded to form a smooth contour.

5.1.2.2 Laimnated plastic-foil bag. The bag shall be fabricated from a material consisting of 0.0025 inch (0.06 mm) thick ionomer or polyethylene film (± 10 percent), laminated or extrusion coated to 0.00035 inch (0.0089 mm) thick ± 10 percent aluminum foil laminated on the plain side to 0.001 inch (0.03 mm) ± 20 percent thick polyester or nylon 6. The polyester or nylon 6 shall be bonded to the aluminum foil by hot extruding 10 pounds per ream (4.5 kg per ream) ± 10 percent of polyethylene between laminae.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T20:46Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

The exterior (polyester or nylon 6) surface of the material shall be colored overall with a color in the number ranges from 34052 to 34108 inclusive, or 20045, 20062 or 30045 of FED-STD-595. Reverse printing of the exterior layer will be acceptable and any luster contributed by the polyester or nylon 6 lamina (external) shall not be considered as affecting the color gloss. The combined sheet material shall show no evidence of delamination before or after heat sealing. The laminated material shall be suitably formulated for food products in compliance with the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder. The interior surface of the laminated material shall not impart any undesirable odor or flavor to the product. The bag shall be a flat style bag having the inside dimensions of either 6 by 10 inches (152 by 254 mm) ± 1/8 inch (± 3 mm) or 6 by 1-5/8 inch (152 by 270 mm) ± 1/8 inch (± 3 mm) and shall be heat sealed on three edges with 3/8 inch (10 mm) wide seals ± 1/8 inch (± 3 mm). One side of the open end of the bag may be provided with a 1/4 inch ± 1/16 inch (6 mm ± 2 mm) extended or fold-over lip to facilitate opening and filling. The laminated bag material shall have an average seal strength of not less than 6 pounds per linear inch (1.05 kN/m) and no individual seal strength specimen being less than 5 pounds per linear inch (0.88 kN/m) when tested in accordance with 4.6.6. A V-shaped or C-shaped (half round) tear notch at least 1/32 inch (1 mm) deep, located 1-1/4 to 1-1/2 inch (32 to 38 mm) from the top edge of the bag shall be made in both side seals. The distance between the inside edge of the tear notch and the inside edge of the seal shall be at least 3/16 inch (5 mm). The unit pack shall be closed as specified in 5.1.2.2.1.

* 5.1.2.2.1 Closure of filled laminated plastic-foil bag. The filled laminated bag shall be evacuated and closed by heat sealing the open end above the tear notches in a vacuum of not less than 28 inches of mercury (an absolute pressure of not more than 6 kPa) as registered on a vacuum gauge on the closing machine. After a storage period of 24 hours or more following the unit pack closing operation, an examination shall be made of each unit pack to determine compliance with the vacuum requirements (see 4.5.4.1 for procedure). The closure seal shall be not less than 1/4 inch (6 mm) nor more than 1/2 inch (13 mm) wide and shall have an average seal strength of not less than 6 pounds per linear inch (1.05 kN/m) with no individual seal specimen less than 5 pounds per linear inch (0.88 kN/m) when tested in accordance with 4.6.6. Alternatively, an optional double seal may be applied to close the bags. The double closure seal shall be at least 5/16 inch (8 mm) wide and shall have an average seal strength of 6 pounds per linear inch (1.05 kN/m) and no individual specimen shall have a strength of less than 5 pounds per linear inch (0.88 kN/m) when tested in accordance with 4.6.6. If thermal impulse sealing is used for the closure seal, a seal width of not less than 1/8 inch (± 3 mm) is required. The unit pack shall be labeled in accordance with 5.4, subsequent to the closing operation. Unit packs which are improperly sealed or fail to maintain vacuum after sealing may be resealed or the contents may be placed in a new laminated plastic-foil bag and resealed.

5.1.3 Level C. The product shall be packaged in accordance with 5.1.1, except that cans with or without commercial exterior coating will be acceptable.

5.2 Packing. Six size 603 by 700 cans of the product, arranged three in length, two in width and one in depth shall be packed on end in a snug-fitting shipping container in accordance with level A, B or C, as specified (see 6.1). The style RSC shipping container may be top-opening or end-opening. Flexible packages shall be packed in accordance with 5.2.4.

5.2.1 Level A packing. The shipping container shall be a fiberboard box constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC, V2s, of PPP-B-636.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T20:46Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.2.2 Level B packing. The shipping container shall be a fiberboard box constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC, V3c, V3s or V4s of PPP-B-636.

5.2.2.1 Nonmetallic reinforcement of shipping containers. When specified (see 6.1 and 6.3), the shipping container specified in 5.2.2 shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure sensitive adhesive, filament reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.3 Level C packing. The shipping container shall be in accordance with the Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification, as applicable.

* 5.2.4 Level C packing (for shipment of flexibly packaged food to the ration assembler. Forty-five filled and sealed food unit packs preserved as specified in 5.1.2 shall be packed in a fiberboard box with liner complying with the Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification, as applicable. In addition, top and bottom pads constructed of the same material as the shipping container shall be used in packing. The unit packs shall be packed flat or nested in three layers of 15 unit packs each. Each unit pack shall be packed with its excess package material maintained in the flat (unfolded) state. Dunnage material not less than 1/8 inch (3 mm) thick conforming to type II, class B of PPP-C-843, or dunnage material not less than 1/16 inch (2 mm) thick conforming to PPP-C-1797, shall be placed between each of the three layers of unit packs and in the bottom and top of the cases to minimize movement of each individual packet. The length and width of the pieces of dunnage material shall be not less than the length and width of the shipping container. Each box shall be securely closed in accordance with method II as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.3 Unitized loads. When specified (see 6.1), the product packed as specified in 5.2, shall be arranaged in unitized loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified.

* 5.4 Labeling and marking.

5.4.1 Cans. Cans shall be labeled in accordance with MIL-L-1497 and, in addition, shall contain the following information:

Name of product
List of ingredients
Net weight
Directions for use
GAS PACKED

5.4.1.1 Directions for use (cans). The following directions for use, as applicable, shall be lithographed on the body or on one end of the can:



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T20:46Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Type I - Chicken diced

| | |
|---|---|
| Chicken diced | 1 can (20 ounces) |
| Water, hot (180° - 200°F) | 3-3/4 quarts |
| Salt | 2 tablespoons |

Place hot water in container. Add salt.
Add contents of can to hot water.
Stir, cover, and let stand 20 minutes or longer.
Drain.
Use in any recipe requiring cooked, diced chicken.
For salad, refrigerate at once in a small-sized covered container and use at the next meal.
Substitute 20 ounces (1 can) cooked dehydrated chicken for 12-1/2 pounds fresh chicken, ready-to-cook, or 3-1/3 pounds fresh chicken, cooked and boned.

* 5.4.2 Unit packs (food packets). Each unit pack shall have labeling that complies with the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder. The label shall be pressure sensitive, a dull non-reflective color other than white and all printing thereon shall be black, boldface, legible type with indelible ink. The label shall be applied to one face of the bag with sufficient pressure to assure its adherence to the packet. The labels shall contain the following information:

NAME OF PRODUCT

TEAR OUTER BAG OPEN AT NOTCHES

CAUTION - INNER BAG IS OPEN ON ONE SIDE

REMOVE IT CAREFULLY HOLDING OUTER BAG UPRIGHT TO AVOID SPILLING CONTENTS

ADD 1/2 CANTEEN CUP HOT OR COLD WATER TO FOOD IN BAG.

LET SOAK ABOUT 5 MINUTEES. ADD MORE WATER IF DESIRED.

MAY BE EATEN DRY.

NET. WT. 4-5/8 AVD. OZ. (131 g)

NAME AND ADDRESS OF PRODUCER

USDA INSPECTION MARKING

5.4.2.1 Alternative printing on unit packs (food packets). Alternatively, the above information may be printed directly on the bag with indelible black ink. When printing is applied directly to the bag it shall be located in an area that will permit the printing to be legible after vacuum sealing.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T20:46Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.4.3 Shipping containers. Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.4.4 Unitized loads. Unitized loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Type of product required (see 1.2).
(c) When a first article is required (see 3.1).
(d) Type of package required (see 5.1).
(e) Level of preservation and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(f) When nonmetallic reinforcement is required for level B packing (see 5.2.2.1).
(g) Type and class of unitized load when unitized loading is specified (see 5.3).

6.2 Appropriate level of pack. Based on conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling, and storage of the specific item being procured, the contracting officer should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15/NAVSUPINST 4030.28/AFR 71-6/MCO 4030.33A/DLAR 4145.7.

6.3 Intended use of nonmetallic reinforcement of shipping containers. Packing specified in 5.2.2.1 is intended for transfer at sea operations and specific overseas operations.

6.4 Award of contracts. Award of contract for the product specified in this document will be limited to plants known to maintain the required sanitation conditions of 3.5 and 4.3.

6.5 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of DAR 7-104.55. The first article shall be a preproduction sample. The first article should consist of 12 cans or polyethylene bags. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all procurement instruments regarding arrangements for inspection and approval of the first article.

6.6 Metric equivalents. Metric equivalents, indicated in parentheses throughout this document, are based on practices, conversion factors, and symbols specified in ASTM E 380 Standard for Metric Practice and are for information only. In each instance, the value stated in US customary units shall be controlling.



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-21T20:46Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6.7 Changes from previous issue. The margins of this specification are marked with an asterisk to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Review activities:

Army - MD
Navy - MC
DSA - SS

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8905-0812



Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T20:46Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

# STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

INSTRUCTIONS: This form is provided to solicit beneficial comments which may improve this document and enhance its use. DoD contractors, government activities, manufacturers, vendors, or other prospective users of the document are invited to submit comments to the government. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity. Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity. A response will be provided to the submitter, when name and address is provided, within 30 days indicating that the 1426 was received and when any appropriate action on it will be completed.
NOTE: This form shall not be used to submit requests for waivers, deviations or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER *(Number)* AND TITLE
MIL-C-43135H
Chicken And Chicken Products Cooked, Dehydrated

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS OF SUBMITTER

☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER

1. ☐ HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE? ☐ IS ANY PART OF IT TOO RIGID, RESTRICTIVE, LOOSE OR AMBIGUOUS? PLEASE EXPLAIN BELOW.

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING

B. RECOMMENDED WORDING CHANGE

C. REASON FOR RECOMMENDED CHANGE(S)

2. REMARKS

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and address — Optional)*

TELEPHONE NO.

DATE

DD FORM 1426
1 OCT 76

EDITION OF 1 JAN 72 WILL BE USED UNTIL EXHAUSTED.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-21T20:46Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

FOLD

DEPARTMENT OF THE ARMY

OFFICIAL BUSINESS
PENALTY FOR PRIVATE USE $300

NO POSTAGE
NECESSARY
IF MAILED
IN THE
UNITED STATES

**BUSINESS REPLY CARD**

FIRST CLASS PERMIT NO. 12062 WASHINGTON D. C.

POSTAGE WILL BE PAID BY THE DEPARTMENT OF THE ARMY

Commander
US Army Natick Research and Development Command
ATTN: DRDNA-ES
Natick, MA 01760

FOLD

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T20:46Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.